

HYUNDAI CRETA

HAIL TO THE KING

THE HYUNDAI CRETA GETS MAJOR UPDATES, LOOKS SET TO CONTINUE AS SEGMENT LEADER

BY DHRUV SAXENA

Just under four years after the arrival of the second generation Creta, Hyundai has given its bestseller a major overhaul with a significant redesign of the exterior and interior, more features, enhanced safety and a new turbo petrol powertrain.

Both the front and rear sport a completely new design, dropping the outgoing version's curvy elements in favour of a more squared-off approach. There's a full-length LED light bar ending in inverted L-shapes at its extremities upfront, complemented by an identical design for the stop lamps at the back. The headlamps, LEDs in case of higher-end trims, sit lower down detached from the DRLs. The new rectangular grille sports a dark chrome finish and there's a healthy use of black cladding on the bumpers which, along with grey lower sections, imparts a more rugged look than before. When viewed from the side, the new iteration's relation to the older one becomes instantly apparent with the only change coming in the form of a new design for the 17-inch two-tone alloy wheels. A new colour in the form of a rather regal shade of green has been added to the colour mix. There's only one dual-tone colour option—white with a black roof.

For the cabin, Hyundai has opted for lighter tones compared to the outgoing model, resulting in a slightly heightened feeling of space inside. This dual-tone, shades of grey interior theme is now standard across all variants, even the petrol turbo. Adding some colour to the otherwise monochromatic cabin are bronze highlights that adorn the edge of the screens, the engine start/stop button and the seats.

What has significantly changed inside is the dashboard layout with a twin 10.25-inch screen set-up. Variants lower down the pecking order get an 8-inch touchscreen. The fully digital instrument cluster comes with the same Eco, Normal and Sport themes synced with the drive modes. It is restricted only to the top-end SX(O) trim, though. The aircon has been upgraded from a single zone to a dual zone one adding to the list of creature comforts the Creta comes equipped with, including ventilated front seats, an 8-speaker Bose audio set-up, panoramic sunroof, wireless phone charger, two-step recline for the rear bench and electrically adjustable driver's seat to name a few. The air purifier has now been incorporated within the aircon set-up. Safety has been enhanced as well with the inclusion of a 360-degree camera with front and rear parking sensors and ADAS (driver assistance features).

Hyundai Creta SX(O)
Engine 1,497 cc 4-cyl petrol; 1,493 cc 4-cyl diesel
Power 115 bhp@6,300 rpm; 116 bhp@4,000 rpm
Price ₹18.70-20 lakh (ex-showroom)

The 1.5-litre naturally aspirated petrol and the 1.5-litre diesel engine options continue to offer manual and automatic transmission options. Hyundai has dropped the IMT variants, citing weak demand. There's no discernible difference in the way the new Creta drives vis-a-vis the older one.

The 2024 Hyundai Creta range starts from Rs 11 lakh (ex-showroom), going all the way up to Rs 20 lakh (ex-showroom) for the range-topping diesel AT and turbo petrol DCT variants. That translates to an increase in price across the line-up, but the increment is most significant in the case of the range-topping SX(O) trims. The Hyundai Creta was already the default choice for most buyers in this segment and with the facelift, it looks set to continue its dominance in the segment, further cementing its place in the bestsellers list. ■